GG-S-00816c
Amendment - 2
November 5, 1969
SUPERSEDING
Amendment - 1
August 23, 1968

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SUTURE, NONABSORBABLE, SURGICAL (NONMETALLIC)

This amendment was developed by Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, 19101, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this amendment as a valid exception to Interim Federal Specification GG-S-00816c, dated 8 December 1965.

* 3.3.3 Size. Delete period (.) at end of paragraph and add: "except for Class I silk sutures delete entirely U.S.P. paragraph entitled 'Diameter', and that portion of the table in U.S.P. referring to Limits.

	Diameter (mm) - Range		
Size	Lower Control Point	Mid-Point	Upper Control Point
8-0	0.038	0.045	0.051
7-0	0.051	0.064	0.076
6-0	0.076	0.089	0.102
5-0	0.114	0.133	0.152
4-0	0.165	0.184	0.203
3-0	0.216	0.235	0.254
2-0	0.279	0.305	0.330
1-0	0.356	0.381	0.406
1	0.431	0.457	0.483
2	0.508	0.534	0.559
3	0.584	0.610	0.635
4	0.660	0.686	0.711

FSC 6515

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Determine the diameter of 10 strands of suture as directed under 'Sutures-Diameter', page 918. The average of the 30 measurements on the 10 strand sample shall be within the limits of the diameter range for the size being measured. For sizes 6-0 and smaller: in no case shall an individual measurement be more than 10 percent below the lower control point of size being measured and in no case shall it be greater than the mid-point for the next larger size. For sizes 5-0 and larger: in no case shall an individual measurement be less than the upper control point for the next smaller size, nor greater than the mid-point for the next larger size. Twenty-eight (28) of the thirty (30) individual diameter measurements shall be within the parameters described herein.

3.3.4 Length. Delete first sentence entirely and substitute: "Length shall be in accordance with the requirements of the current edition of the U.S.P."

Add the following paragraph:

* "3.3.7 Tensile strength. For Class I silk sutures delete that portion of the table in U.S.P. paragraph entitled 'Tensile Strength' listing limits on knot-pull tensile strength and substitute the following for each respective size:

SIZE	LIMITS ON KNOT-PULL TENSILE STRENGTH (Kg)** -CLASS L	
	(A) - Average of 10 strands	(B) - Minimum per strand
8-0	0.08	0.04
7-0	0.14	0.06
6-0	0.25	0.15
5-0	0.50	0.22
4-0	0.75	0.30
3-0	1.20	0.75
2-0	1.80	1.26
1-0	2.70	1.75
1	3.40	2.24
2	4.40	2.50
3	5.00	3.00

Failure of sutures to comply with requirements of either 'average of 10 strands' or 'minimum per strand', or both, shall be cause for rejection of the lot being tested."

** The limits on tensile strength apply to sutures that have not been sterilized; for sterilized sutures, the limits are 20 percent lower.

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3.9 Labels. Line 5, delete "nonboilable".

Add new paragraphs:

"3.11 Requirements of statutes. Compliance with all requirements and statutes and regulations, promulgated thereunder, is mandatory for the contents, immediate container, labeling, and marking of any commodity governed by the requirement of any of the following: U.S. Pharmacopeia, National Formulary (N.F.), National Institutes of Health, Food and Drug Administration, Agricultural Research Service, Internal Revenue Service, Interstate Commerce Commission or any other Federal or state laws or regulations; shall conform to the standards and or requirements of the applicable regulations or laws. Any inconsistency which exists or may appear to exist between the requirements of the foregoing and the requirements of the procurement document shall be brought to the attention of the Defense Personnel Support Center for resolution.

"3.11.1 Ingredients. The ingredients entering into the preparation or manufacture of a product shall comply with the tests, standards, and requirements of the U.S.P. or N.F., and the procurement document. If the ingredients are not monographed in the U.S.P. or N.F., and standards for the ingredients are not included in the procurement document, the ingredients shall be of a high quality and purity and suitable for use in the product.

"3.11.2 Testing of ingredients. Ingredients that are official in the U.S.P. or N.F. shall be tested by the methods described in the U.S.P. or N.F. and the procurement document, and the ingredients shall comply with the above paragraph. Ingredients that are not official in the U.S.P. or N.F. shall be tested by the methods specified in the procurement document or, if not specified therein, the nonofficial ingredients shall be tested by suitable methods to determine their identity and compliance with the above.

"3.11.3 U.S.P. and N.F. monographed ingredients and end items. Alternative assay methods and test procedures not permitted.

"3.11.4 Unless otherwise expressly indicated in schedule or in the applicable specifications, end items deliverable hereunder, as well as ingredients of such end items, shall be subject to assay and test procedures described in the applicable monographs of the U.S.P. and N.F. Alternative methods not described in the U.S.P. and N.F. are not permitted.

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"3.11.5 Commingling of ingredients. The Government must be able to isolate specific lots of the active ingredients and the production of such active ingredients contained in material being purchased, to facilitate the investigation of complaints or recalls received after delivery and acceptance, and to minimize the quantities suspended pending completion of testing. Therefore, the commingling of the same active ingredient produced by different manufacturing facilities in any one production lot is prohibited.

"3.11.6 Inspection and acceptance of material shall be based upon sampling, examination, and testing of each lot, in accordance with the procurement document. Compliance with all test requirements shall be mandatory."

4.1.2 Certificates of quality. Delete entirely.

* 4.2.3 For tests (including diameter). In Table II, under column "Component", add the following between "Suture and needle" and "as applicable":

Component	Character-istic	Reqmt.	Test procedure	Inspection level	Minimum number of samples to be tested	Accep-tance number
Suture	Sterility	3.7	4.4.8	6/	6/	0
Inner container	Sterility	3.7	4.4.8	6/	6/	0

Under note 5/, add:

"6/ A minimum of 20 samples shall be selected from each sterilizer load."

Add the following paragraph:

"4.4.9 Tensile strength test. Test for tensile strength shall be performed on 10 strands as specified in the current edition of the U.S.P. and shall comply with the requirements of columns (A) and (B) of Limits on Knot-Pull Tensile Strength specified in 3.3.7. If one of these 10 strands is below the minimum strength specified in column (B), 20 new strands from the same lot of sutures shall be tested for tensile strength as specified above. Each of these 20 strands shall comply with the requirements of column (B) of Limits on Knot-pull Tensile Strength specified in 3.3.7. Therefore, of the 30 measurements not more than one shall be below the requirements of column (B)."

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5.1.3.2 Intermediate package. Line 2, following "PPP-B-636", delete "type 1, class 1" and substitute: "type CF, class domestic."

* 5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Line 2, following "PPP-B-585," delete remainder of paragraph and substitute: "class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3."

* 5.2.1.4 Strapping. Delete subparagraph headed "NOTE:".

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Delete entirely and substitute:

* "5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification"

* 5.3.1 (k). Delete "and 'NON-BOILABLE'."
* 5.3.1 (l). Delete "3.9" and substitute: "3.8". Add: "5.3.1 (m). The method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, S-Steam, D-Dry Heat Sterilization) shall be shown following the level of packaging and the date of packaging. 'Example: A-9/69-G.' Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date."

* 5.3.2 Intermediate package. At end of paragraph add: "The method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1 shall also be shown."

5.3.3 Exterior container. At end of paragraph add: "The method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1 shall also be shown."

Add the following paragraph:

* "6.3 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additons, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue."

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